

Willie McClain

Cybersecurity Analyst | SOC Analyst | Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dedicated Cybersecurity professional with a B.S. in Information Assurance and hands-on experience in SIEM log analysis, network defense, and vulnerability management. Combines 5+ years of financial industry operational experience with strong investigative skills used to detect anomalies, enforce strict Identity & Access Management (IAM), and mitigate fraud. Proven ability to engineer simulated SOC environments and perform root cause analysis, bridging the gap between complex data and actionable incident response.

EDUCATION

Western Governors University

Master of Science in Data Analytics (Data Science Specialization)

Relevant Coursework: Advanced Data Visualization, Machine Learning, Predictive Analytics, Data Mining.

Salt Lake City, UT

Expected: August 2028

Capella University

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology (Information Assurance and Cybersecurity)

Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Incident Response, Secure Database Design.

Minneapolis, MN

Graduated: January 2025

CERTIFICATIONS

- Data Operations Certificate
- Data Analytics Professional Certificate
- Data Science Professional Specialization
- In Progress:** CompTIA Security+
- In Progress:** CompTIA Network+

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Defensive & Offensive Security Home Lab (Simulated SOC)

2025

- Tools:** Splunk (SIEM), VMware, pfSense, OpenVPN, Nmap, Wireshark.
- Outcome:** Architected a segmented network environment; successfully ingested and analyzed 10,000+ daily network events to detect 10/10 simulated malicious intrusions.
- Learned:** SIEM log analysis, alert triage, firewall hardening, threat hunting, and zero-trust segmentation principles.

Financial Transaction Anomaly Detection System

2025

- Tools:** Python (Scikit-learn, Pandas), SQL, Matplotlib, SMOTE.
- Outcome:** Deployed a machine learning model via a Streamlit web interface, achieving 95%+ accuracy in evaluating real-time transaction parameters and assigning automated risk/threat scores.
- Learned:** Handling imbalanced security datasets, minimizing false positives, and scripting automated responses for real-time threat flows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cybersecurity & SOC Tools

- SIEM & Log Analysis (Splunk)
- Incident Response & Triage
- Vulnerability Scanning (Nmap)
- Network Security (Firewalls, VPNs)
- Identity & Access (IAM, RBAC, MFA)
- Threat Hunting & Anomaly Detection
- OSINT & Threat Intelligence

Governance, Risk & Compliance

- Compliance (PCI-DSS, GDPR, GLBA)
- Risk Assessments (RCSA)
- Internal Controls (SOX)
- BSA / AML / OFAC Protocols
- SARs Filing & Investigation
- Audit Trail Documentation
- Zero-Trust Architecture

Scripting & Data Analysis

- Python (Pandas, Automation)
- SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL, T-SQL)
- Machine Learning (Scikit-learn)
- Data Visualization (Tableau)
- Advanced Excel (Macros, VLOOKUP)
- Financial Fraud Prevention
- Data Pipelines

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Independent Contractor

Freelance Software Developer & Technical Researcher

Fort Worth, TX & Remote

April 2025 – Present

- Cybersecurity & AI Development:** Created and published 3+ custom open-source projects on GitHub, demonstrating self-taught expertise in secure system architecture, threat detection logic, and secure API integrations.
- Self-Taught Mobile & Web Creation:** Independently learned, architected, and deployed 2 cross-platform applications, implementing secure coding practices across the full software lifecycle.
- Applied Data Science:** Self-directed the creation of machine learning models to analyze datasets exceeding 50,000 records for predictive anomalies, showcasing complex technical problem-solving.

Fidelity Investments

Financial Customer Advocate

Westlake, TX

February 2026 – Present

- Identity & Account Security:** Safeguard client assets within a high-volume 401k contact center by executing strict identity verification protocols to authenticate participants and prevent fraudulent account access.
- Client Advocacy & Support:** Guide participants through complex financial hardship processes, providing empathetic support and resolving sensitive account issues with a focus on customer advocacy.
- Regulatory Compliance & Education:** Educate clients on 401k plan mechanics, distributions, and policy guidelines, ensuring all interactions strictly adhere to regulatory boundaries prohibiting unauthorized financial advice.

Emerging Products - Student Debt Operations

November 2025 – February 2026

- High-Volume Operations:** Orchestrated the end-to-end processing of 30–50 daily financial transactions, maintaining a 99.8% accuracy rate in a high-volume, regulated environment.
- Compliance & Audit:** Conducted rigorous quality assurance audits on payment documentation to validate data integrity and ensure strict adherence to federal compliance standards.
- Process Optimization:** Leveraged data analysis to identify operational bottlenecks, engineering workflow adjustments that increased daily team throughput by 15%.

Financial Customer Associate

July 2023 – November 2025

- Root Cause Analysis & Investigation:** Diagnosed and resolved complex account discrepancies, utilizing internal database tools to investigate transaction histories and identify root causes of anomalies.
- Identity & Access Control (IAM):** Enforced strict identity authentication protocols (MFA) prior to account access, acting as the first line of defense against social engineering, phishing attempts, and unauthorized data exposure.
- Transaction Integrity:** Executed sensitive financial transactions with zero tolerance for error, strictly safeguarding client assets against fraudulent activity.

Customer Relations Advocate

February 2023 – July 2023

- Regulatory Training:** Engaged in rigorous study of federal securities regulations and conflict resolution protocols (SIE/Series 7 curriculum) to build a foundational understanding of financial compliance laws.
- Identity & Access Support:** Managed secure password resets and website troubleshooting for participants, applying strict identity verification standards learned during regulatory coursework to prevent unauthorized access.

HONOR SOCIETIES & AFFILIATIONS

ISACA (Information Systems Audit and Control Association)

Student Member

Schaumburg, IL

February 2025 – March 2026

- Action:** Engaged with enterprise risk management frameworks and professional community resources to bridge the gap between academic theory and practical application.
- Outcome:** Gained actionable expertise in evolving audit standards and cybersecurity governance, directly enhancing readiness for risk assessment roles.

Order of the Sword and Shield National Honor Society (OSSNHS)

Inducted Member

Bay Shore, NY

January 2025 – March 2026

- Action:** Maintained superior academic performance and upheld the strict ethical codes and leadership standards required by the security community.
- Outcome:** Earned induction into this highly selective network, validating technical academic excellence and demonstrating a strong commitment to industry ethics.

National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE)

Collegiate Member

Alexandria, VA

January 2023 – May 2025

- Action:** Participated in technical workshops and national conferences while actively engaging in peer mentorship initiatives to foster an inclusive tech environment.
- Outcome:** Expanded technical knowledge, built a robust professional network with industry leaders, and accelerated overall career readiness in the technology sector.